

NEUROSYNC · VOLUME I

A Book of Inspirations

*Three quiet directions for a brainwave focus tool
— moving from laboratory to landscape.*

Prepared for the Board · Spring 2026
Design Studio Edition



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What you'll find inside

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*Each chapter is a complete worldview: palette, typography, iconography, microcopy, and the references that earned a place in our notebooks. Use the dots on the right to jump between chapters. Press **Cmd/Ctrl + P** to print or save the whole book as a PDF.*

The Brief

From a futuristic lab to a place a person actually wants to sit.

BOARD FEEDBACK (VERBATIM)

"The UI looks like it's for futuristic tech people, not for the people who use brainwaves as a way of working. The design needs to connect more to nature, earthy colors, less computer-like vibes."

WHAT THAT MEANS IN DESIGN LANGUAGE

Drop the navy-and-cyan dashboard energy. Replace it with surfaces that feel *held*, not operated. Bring in earthy colors, a serif voice, subtle paper grain, slower motion. Keep every feature; only the skin and the tone change.

THREE CONCEPTS ON OFFER

- **Forest Floor** — earthy, woodsy, golden hour
- **Stone & Tide** — quiet, ceramic, contemplative
- **Dawn Garden** — warm, hopeful, morning routine

CONSTRAINTS

Single-file HTML/CSS/JS app. No new dependencies. All features retained: Pomodoro presets, focus journeys, timer, entrainment engine (5 bands), ambient mixer, internet

radio, brain dump. Light + dark themes both required. **Light mode is the hero** for all three concepts — a deliberate shift from the current dark-first identity.

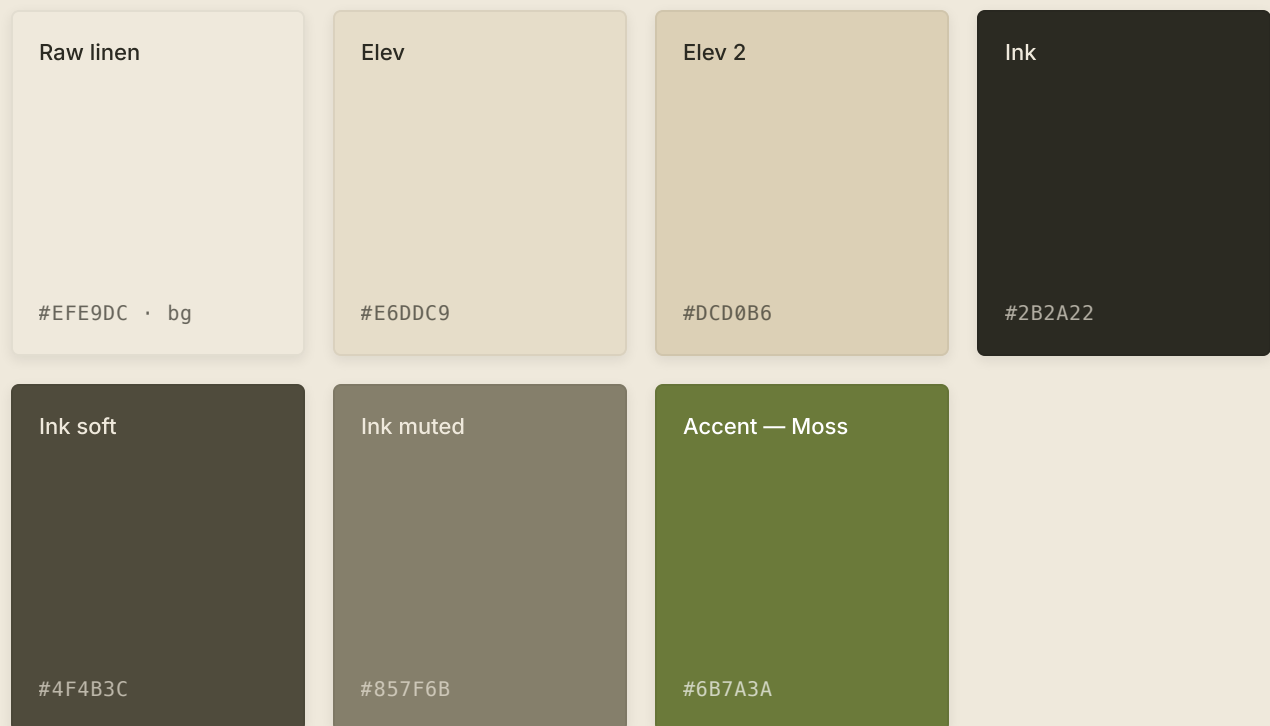
Forest Floor

Sitting cross-legged on damp earth at golden hour. A clearing, not a dashboard.

The mood

Light filters through canopy in slow drifts. The app should feel like a place you *arrive at* — quiet, breathable, slightly humid. Moss underfoot, bark in your peripheral vision, a single shaft of sun.

LIGHT PALETTE



DARK PALETTE



#1A1A14 · bg

#23231B

#2E2D22

#9CAE5E

BRAINWAVE BANDS — COOL EARTH TO WARM CLAY

Delta

#3D4A2E

Theta

#5C6B3F

Alpha

#A89B5C

Beta

#C77A3E

Gamma

#B84A28

TYPOGRAPHY — FRAUNCES + INTER

Begin sitting.

Fraunces · 56px · opsz 144 · weight 400

25:00

Fraunces tabular figures · monospace dies

TEXTURE — SUBTLE, PRESSED PAPER

Paper grain · 4% multiply · pressed

ICONOGRAPHY — NATURAL METAPHORS



Sprout · focus



Stoneware mug · short break



Moon over hill · long break



Cairn · presets

MICROCOPY — QUIETER INVITATIONS

Start Session

Begin sitting

Entrainment Engine

Tuning

Brain Dump

Let it go

ANIMATION FEEL

Everything *settles*. No springs, no bounces — only eased decays. The timer ring breathes 4s @ scale 1.000→1.004. Press = pebble ripple outward. Phase transitions cross-fade with cubic-bezier(0.25, 0.46, 0.45, 0.94) @ 600ms.

THE BOLD MOVE

Replace the rectangular timer card with a hand-drawn irregular blob shape. The timer sits in a clearing, not a card.

REFERENCES & INSPIRATIONS

Andy Goldsworthy land art, leaf cairns

goldsworthy.cc.gla.ac.uk

Forest app focus + nature

forestapp.cc

Insight Timer library of practice

insighttimer.com

Endel organic generative motion

endel.io

Are.na · moss collaborative moodboard

are.na/search/moss

Fraunces variable serif

fonts.google.com/Fraunces

Blobmaker organic SVG shapes

blobmaker.app

Rinko Kawauchi soft natural light

rinkokawauchi.com

Oak Meditation quiet UI

oakmeditation.com

Opal screen-time, earthy refresh

opal.so

Farrow & Ball paint palette study

farrow-ball.com

Are.na · forest floor texture pool

[are.na/search/forest floor](http://are.na/search/forest%20floor)

Phosphor Icons duotone option

phosphoricons.com

Grainy gradients SVG noise tutorial

grainy-gradients.vercel.app

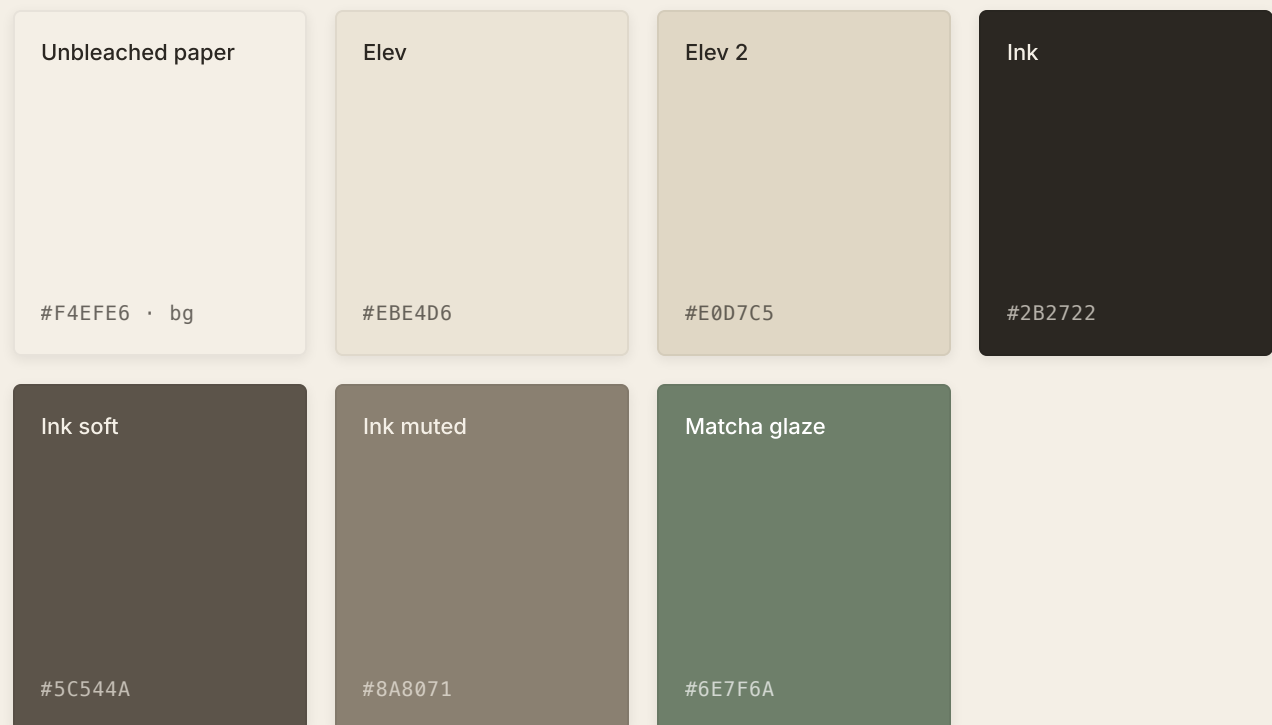
Stone & Tide

Tea room at dawn. Paper light through shoji. A river stone on raw linen.

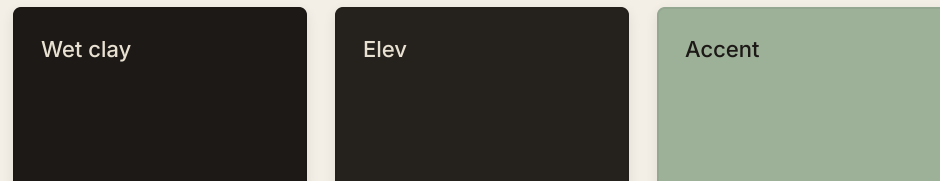
The mood

The hush before a bell. Nothing hums or glows — surfaces breathe, edges soften, time pools instead of ticks. The app should feel *held*, not operated. Wabi-sabi in CSS.

LIGHT PALETTE (HERO)



DARK PALETTE



#1C1916 · bg

#25221E

#9DB098

BRAINWAVE BANDS — GLAZED CERAMICS

Delta

#4A5258 ·
iron slate

Theta

#6B5D7A ·
amethyst

Alpha

#7A9080 ·
celadon

Beta

#B8754A ·
persimmon

Gamma

#8B3A2E ·
oxblood

TYPOGRAPHY — FRAUNCES VARIABLE + INTER

The bell.

Fraunces · italic · weight softens over session (500 → 380)

25:00

Tabular figures · digits soften as mind softens

TEXTURE — PAPER GRAIN BAKED IN

Washi turbulence · multiply blend

ICONOGRAPHY — SUMI-E BRUSHSTROKES, 1.25PX STROKE



Sun · focus



Moon · break



Tide · journey



Empty bowl · trash

MICROCOPY — CEREMONY, NOT COMMANDS

Start Focus

Begin

Session Complete!

The bell.

Reset Timer

Set it down

ANIMATION FEEL

Everything moves on the *exhale* curve — cubic-bezier(0.22, 0.61, 0.36, 1) @ 680ms. The timer doesn't tick; it *fills like ink bleeding into paper*. Idle ring breathes on a 4.2s cycle, scale 1.00 → 1.012. No spinners — only a slow tide-line.

THE BOLD MOVE

The timer is a stone, not a ring. A top-down river stone that gets visibly wet as the session progresses. Completion = fully glazed stone.

REFERENCES & INSPIRATIONS

Hiroshi Sugimoto · Seascapes horizon
minimalism
sugimotohiroshi.com

Axel Vervoordt quiet interiors
axel-vervoordt.com

Bear writing app
bear.app

Stoic. journal contemplative iOS
getstoic.com

Reeder 5 typographic clarity
reederapp.com

MUJI off-white discipline
muji.com

Are.na · wabi-sabi moodboard pool
are.na/wabi-sabi

Ryōan-ji rock garden Kyoto
ryoanji.jp

iA Writer restraint master
ia.net/writer

Things 3 Cultured Code
culturedcode.com/things

Day One journaling reference
dayoneapp.com

Heath Ceramics glaze palette
heathceramics.com

Klim · Söhne quiet sans
klim.co.nz/sohne

Are.na · ceramics moodboard pool
are.na/ceramics

Dawn Garden

First light through a kitchen window. Linen curtains, ceramic mug, dew on sage.

The mood

Soft, generous, unhurried — the app feels like it's already breathing slowly *with* you. Hand-touched but never twee. Confident enough to sit on a designer's home screen, gentle enough for someone who hasn't opened their eyes fully yet.

LIGHT PALETTE

Warm paper

#FBF4EA · bg

Elev

#FFFBF4

Elev 2

#F4E8D6

Ink

#2E2A26

Ink soft

#5C5249

Ink muted

#9A8C7E

Terracotta

#D97757

DARK PALETTE

Banked ember

Elev

Dusk peach

#1F1A18 · bg

#2A2320

#E89372

BRAINWAVE BANDS — PETALS & DAWN SKY

Delta

#8A6FA6 ·
lavender

Theta

#C97B6E ·
terracotta

Alpha

#E0A86B ·
apricot

Beta

#9DB17C ·
sage

Gamma

#F1C266 ·
pollen

TYPOGRAPHY — GENERAL SANS + FRAUNCES ITALIC

Morning Clarity

a session in three quiet acts

General Sans (UI) + Fraunces italic (accents)

25:00

TEXTURE — GRADIENT MESH + NOISE

Mesh wash · dawn radial · 4% noise

ICONOGRAPHY — GEOMETRIC BASE, HAND-TOUCHED SOUL



Seedling · focus



Bud · break



Bloom · long break



Sun · journey

MICROCOPY — WARMER, MORE HUMAN

Start Session

Begin where you are

Reset Timer

Start over, gently

Brain Dump

Set it down · a place for the noisy thoughts

ANIMATION FEEL

Everything eases on cubic-bezier(0.22, 0.61, 0.36, 1) @ 480ms. Play button = petal unfurl 600ms. Ring progress breathes $\pm 1.5\%$ scale on a 5.5s loop. *Water, not rubber.*

THE BOLD MOVE

Replace the circular timer ring with a slowly blooming watercolor flower. Petals fill as minutes elapse; fully open at session end. The ring becomes the reward, not the cage.

REFERENCES & INSPIRATIONS

Headspace illustration system

headspace.com

Loóna story-driven calm

loona.app

Balance meditation guided practice

balanceapp.com

Studio Ghibli · Totoro color study

ghibli.jp/works/totoro

General Sans warm humanist

fontshare.com/general-sans

Mesh gradients generator

meshgradient.com

Lottie · flower bloom animations

lottiefiles.com/flower

Calm warm meditation UI

calm.com

Finch self-care warm gamification

finchcare.com

Apple Health · Mindfulness system reference

apple.com/ios/health

Pantone · Peach Fuzz 2024 palette anchor

pantone.com/2024

DM Serif Display warm numerals

[fonts.google.com/DM Serif](https://fonts.google.com/DM%20Serif)

Rauno Freiberg organic web motion

rauno.me

Are.na · dawn moodboard pool

are.na/dawn

Decision

Three worlds, side by side. One vote, four follow-ups.

AT A GLANCE

	FOREST FLOOR	STONE & TIDE	DAWN GARDEN
<i>Time of day</i>	Golden hour	Dawn / dusk · still	7am morning
<i>Energy</i>	Grounded, woodsy	Quiet, ceremonial	Warm, hopeful
<i>Hero mode</i>	Light	Light	Light
<i>Type voice</i>	Fraunces + Inter	Fraunces variable + Inter	Fraunces italic + General Sans
<i>Bold move</i>	Blob-shape timer	Stone-as-timer	Watercolor flower
<i>Implementation</i>	High (organic SVG)	Medium (stone render)	Medium-high (masks)
<i>Risk</i>	Novelty fatigue	Stone metaphor untested	Drift toward twee
<i>Closest reference</i>	Oak, Forest	iA Writer, Stoic	Headspace, Finch

COMMON GROUND (ALL THREE AGREE)

- **Kill JetBrains Mono.** Tabular serif numerals instead. Drops 80% of the "tech" feel in one move.

- **Add a serif** — Fraunces is the consensus pick (variable, optical sizes, ink-trap warmth).
- **Drop cyan & navy completely.** All palettes are warm-paper light + deep-earth dark.
- **Subtle SVG noise** @ ~4% opacity, multiply-blended.
- **Softer microcopy.** Fewer imperatives, more invitations.
- **Slower motion.** 480–680ms eased exhales, zero bounces or springs.

STUDIO RECOMMENDATION

Stone & Tide. Defensible identity ("the stone app"), lower risk than Forest's blob, more distinctive than Dawn's flower. Variable typography ties beautifully into the entrainment narrative — as the mind softens, so do the digits.

Pull microcopy + texture warmth from Dawn Garden; pull "begin sitting" tone from Forest Floor where it fits. Best of all three lives in the chosen frame.

BOARD DECISION NEEDED

1. Pick a concept — ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☒ HYBRID
2. Approve font swap — Fraunces + Inter, drop JetBrains Mono
3. Approve "bold move" — blob / stone / flower — or defer to v2
4. Approve microcopy direction — quieter, more invitational

— End of Book —